

It is essential that we remember the Civil War as its history still affects us to this day, but in doing so it is important to embrace the complexity and the unvarnished truth of our shared history rather than telling ourselves stories that make us feel more comfortable. Focusing on the evidence of the artifacts, documents, photography, and artwork presented in the following pages is an instructive way to begin your own exploration of the past.

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Christopher W. Wilson". The signature is fluid and cursive, with a long horizontal stroke at the end.

CHRISTOPHER W. WILSON
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